

Capstone Project Instructions- Step 4

Step 4: Plan Database Model

Similarly to planning a front-end control flow, planning a database (or more specifically our database models) is both crucial and challenging. Of course we can dive in and do everything on the fly, but a couple of points to consider: A well planned database model can help us organize data efficiently and effectively. If we define the structure of the database beforehand, we can then ensure that we are storing our data efficiently and we have a blueprint for our code even before we start writing code. With proper planning we can also work more efficiently rather than making up data and relationships on the fly (and changing them on the fly as well!).

If we use our “Facebook for Dogs (and Their Owners)” as an example again. Let’s see how we can start to model out our tables and relationships for the application.

Example on how to Model Data with MongoDB:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QAqK-R9HUhc>

Example Data Model for the DogApp:

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1w55hHFEfD5yhAQzR81eAMvXI0ufsfKeW/view?usp=sharing>

Note: Figma or StarUML are once again the right tools for the job here, but the data diagrams can be made with something as simple as GoogleDocs.

Feel free to share your data model to your mentor. This can be either through GitHub or google docs discussing the structure of the data as well as possible challenges or shortcomings. You do not need approval from your mentor to continue working on the project, but they may have advice on how to improve it.

Do not submit until the entire project is complete, proceed to next step